

Kristen Stopfer

CURRICULUM VITAE

kstopfer@ttu.edu

EDUCATION

- 2030 PhD in Human Development and Family Sciences
Texas Tech University
- 2027 M. A. in Human Development and Family Sciences
Texas Tech University
- 2024 B. S. in Psychology
B. A. in Political Science
Minor in Latin
University of Pittsburgh Honors College | *Summa cum laude*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health, Stress, Cardiovascular system, Immunology, Aging, Bereavement, Close relationships

PUBLICATIONS

2. DuPont, C. M., Weis, T. M., King, J. A., **Stopfer, K. T.**, Clayton, C. K., Marsland, A. L., Kamarck, T. W., Gianaros, P. J., & Scudder, M. R. (2026). Dual-impedance cardiography for the assessment of arterial stiffness: associations with blood pressure, cardiometabolic risk factors, and preclinical atherosclerosis in midlife adults. *Blood Pressure*, 35(1).
<https://doi.org/10.1080/08037051.2025.2600733>
1. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, DeCataldo, M., Marsland, A., Muldoon, M., Scudder, M., Gianaros, P. (2025) Functional and Circulating Indicators of Endothelial Health and their Associations with the American Heart Association's Life's Essential 8. *American Journal of Lifestyle Medicine*.
doi:[10.1177/15598276251408755](https://doi.org/10.1177/15598276251408755)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

6. **Stopfer, K.**, Brown, R. L., & Weiser, D. *Queering Widowhood* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
5. **Stopfer, K.**, Knauft, K., Chiang, S., & Brown, R. L. *Childhood stress, Blood Pressure, & Blood Pressure Variability* [Thesis in preparation]. Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
4. Sun, J., **Stopfer, K.**, DeCataldo, M., Kraynak, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. *Cardiac Autonomic Correlates of High-Field (7T) MRI Markers of Cerebrovascular Health and Brain Aging* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh; Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
3. Li, J., Lindsay, E., **Stopfer, K.**, Scudder, M., Gianaros, P. *Childhood trauma as a moderator of blood pressure reduction during paced breathing in healthy midlife adults: A secondary analysis of the Neurobiology of Adult Health (NOAH) Study* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh; Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
2. Biancamano, D., **Stopfer, K.**, Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. *Associations Between Coping Strategy Variability and Cardiac Autonomic Activity* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Psychology, Florida State

University; Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University;
Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh

1. **Stopfer, K.**, Cirillo, J., DeCataldo, M., DuPont, C., Brown, R. L., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. *Autonomic Correlates of Subclinical CVD in Midlife Adults* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University; Department of Psychology, University of Pittsburgh

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

POSTERS

8. Sun, J., **Stopfer, K.**, DeCataldo, M., Kraynak, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Cardiac Autonomic Correlates of High-Field (7T) MRI Markers of Cerebrovascular Health and Brain Aging* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
7. Biancamano, D., **Stopfer, K.**, Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Associations Between Coping Strategy Variability and Cardiac Autonomic Activity* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
6. **Stopfer, K.**, Cirillo, J., DeCataldo, M., DuPont, C., Brown, R. L., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2026, March 11-14). *Autonomic correlates of subclinical CVD* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 83rd Annual Scientific Meeting, Chicago, US.
5. **Stopfer, K.**, Cirillo, J., Reeves, K., King, J., Kamarck, T., Inagaki, T. K., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2025, March 19-22). *Associations between Social Loss and Blood Pressure in Midlife Adults* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 82nd Annual Scientific Meeting, Seattle, US.
4. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, Reeves, K., King, J., Muldoon, M., Marsland, A., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2025, March 19-22). *Functional and Biological Indicators of Endothelial Function and their Association with the AHA Life's Essential 8* [Poster presentation]. Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine 82nd Annual Scientific Meeting, Seattle, US.
3. Luisi, A., Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, King, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *A comparison of the test-retest reliability of noninvasive endothelial function measures* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK.
2. Cirillo, J., **Stopfer, K.**, Luisi, A., King, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *A novel measure of endothelial function using forearm impedance cardiography* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK.
1. **Stopfer, K.**, King, J., Luisi, A., Cirillo, J., Reeves, K., Bhatt, A., Farago, C., Kamarck, T., Gianaros, P., Scudder, M. (2024, March 20-23). *Longitudinal and multiyear progression of arterial stiffness measured by dual impedance cardiography* [Poster presentation]. American Psychosomatic Society 81st Annual Scientific Meeting, Brighton, UK. ***Citation Poster**

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2026-present Society of Behavioral Medicine (SBM)
2025-present Psychoneuroimmunology Research Society (PNIRS)
2025-present Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)
2023-present Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society
2023-present Eta Sigma Phi Classics Honor Society
2023-present Pi Sigma Alpha Political Science Honor Society
2022-present Psi Chi Psychology Honor Society
2022-present Epsilon Eta Delta Environmental Honors Fraternity

SERVICE ACTIVITIES

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- 2026-present **Member | Excellence & Innovation Committee**
Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
- 2026-present **Secretary | Graduate Student Association**
Department of Human Development & Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
- 2026-present **Member | Health Equity Special Interest Group – Student/Trainee Subcommittee**
Society of Behavioral Medicine (SBM)
- 2026-present **Member | LGBTQ+ Health Special Interest Group**
Society of Behavioral Medicine (SBM)
- 2025-present **Chair | Climate, Health, and Sustainability Special Interest Group**
Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)
- 2025-present **Member | Access and Opportunity Committee**
Psychoneuroimmunology Research Society (PNIRS)
- 2025-present **Member | Emerging Leaders Special Interest Group – Resources Subcommittee**
Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine (SBSM)
- 2023-2024 **Chair | Epsilon Eta Delta Environmental Honors Fraternity**
University of Pittsburgh

COMMUNITY SERVICE

- April 2026 **Tech-Lubbock Community Day** (4 hours)
Texas Tech University
- Nov. 2025 **Center for Early Head Start Toy Drive** (4 hours)
Texas Tech University
- Jan. 2023-24 **MLK Day of Service** (10 hours)
University of Pittsburgh
- 2021-2023 **Pitt Dance Marathon** (120 hours) | *Staff member*
University of Pittsburgh
- March 2023 **Alternative Spring Break** (40 hours)
San Cristóbal Island, Ecuador; University of Pittsburgh
- Aug. 2022 **Pitt Arrival Volunteer** (12 hours)
University of Pittsburgh

AWARDS AND HONORS

- 2026-2027 **UWC Paul Whitfield Horn Fellowship** (\$1000), Texas Tech University
- 2026-2027 **Mary T. Young Scholarship** (\$474), Texas Tech University
- 2026-2027 **Dr. William J. Carter Scholarship** (\$1,026), Texas Tech University

2025-2026	HDFS General Scholarship (\$3,000), Texas Tech University
2024	Citation Poster , Society for Biopsychosocial Science and Medicine
2023-2024	Honors College Scholarship (\$2,500), University of Pittsburgh
2023-2024	Panthers Forward Scholar (\$5,000), University of Pittsburgh
2020-2024	Dean's List , University of Pittsburgh
2020-2024	National Merit Scholarship (\$8,000)
2020	American Association of University Women Scholarship (\$2,500), Easton, PA Branch
2020	General Federation of Women's Clubs Pennsylvania Scholarship (\$1,000), Bangor, PA Branch

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2026-present	Parenting and Early Development (PEDs) Lab Texas Tech University Department of Human Development and Family Sciences Advisor: Dr. Savannah Girod Role: Graduate Researcher (Volunteer) Responsibilities: • Support lab members in psychophysiology training and create training guides for cleaning psychophysiology data • Integrate psychophysiology measures into REDCap for data management
2025-present	Stress, Aging, and Relationships (STAR) Lab Texas Tech University Department of Human Development and Family Sciences Advisor: Dr. Ryan Linn Brown Role: Graduate Researcher Responsibilities: • Collaborate with colleagues to establish new research lab and lay the groundwork for future studies • Lead and write IRB protocol for a project examining psychophysiology in dyads, specifically in caregivers and their spouses who have Alzheimer's disease and related dementias (ADRD) • Create and lead a cross-institutional journal club centered around providing accessible psychophysiology training for trainees and PIs alike • Provide psychophysiology training to fellow lab members and collaborators, including impedance cardiography (ICG), electrocardiography (ECG), continuous blood pressure monitoring, and electrodermal activity (EDA) • Co-author publications centered on key lab domains
2022-2025	Laboratory for Psychophysiology and Health Neuroscience University of Pittsburgh Department of Psychology Advisors: Drs. Pete Gianaros and Mark Scudder Role: Clinical Research Assistant Responsibilities: • Administered psychophysiology measures including electrocardiography (ECG), dual impedance cardiography (d-ICG), continuous blood pressure monitoring, and venous occlusion plethysmography (VOP) • Administered and scored neuropsychological and stress tasks including the Montreal cognitive assessment (MoCA), digit symbol substitution (DSST), multi-source

inference task (MSIT), Stroop, Verbal Fluency, Spatial Recognition Task (SRT), Flanker, Digit Vigilance Task (DVT), and the Paced Auditory Serial Addition Task (PASAT)

- Trained 16 undergraduates in psychophysiology and neuropsychological assessment administration
- Assisted MRI technicians and spoke with participants while they were undergoing MRI protocols
- Scored all psychophysiological data (ECG, d-ICG, blood pressure variability (BPV), and VOP) in Mindware software to prepare data for analysis
- Led 3 independent projects, which involved idea conception, data analysis, and scientific writing

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026

“Lifespan Development” | Texas Tech University

Human Development and Family Sciences Department, Undergraduate Course

Instructor: Dr. Ryan Brown

Role: Graduate Teaching Assistant

Responsibilities:

- Assist students with course-related questions to promote learning and growth
- Create quiz and exam questions to reflect the key takeaways of the course content
- Create & lead in-class activities
- Ensure grading is completed in a timely manner
- Manage technical difficulties related to the Canvas platform and coordinate with students to ensure they can access course content
- Ensure Canvas page meets accessibility requirements

2025

“Family in the Community” & “Community Practicum” | Texas Tech University

Human Development and Family Sciences Department, Undergraduate Course

Instructor: Dr. Shera Thomas-Jackson

Role: Graduate Teaching Assistant

Responsibilities:

- Guest lectured on logic models
- Led panel discussions on community practicum opportunities
- Supported students by assisting with questions related to course material and/or their community partners
- Provided detailed individualized feedback on assignments to promote growth and learning
- Coordinated with instructor to promote clear and efficient dissemination of information as students navigate a new course platform

2022

“Introduction to Neuroscience” | University of Pittsburgh

Department of Neuroscience, Undergraduate Course

Instructor: Dr. Lisa McIlvried

Role: Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Responsibilities:

- Supported students with content comprehension and study strategies during class and office hours
- Created a detailed presentation and conducted a review session to ensure students felt confident leading up to their exam

- Ensured lectures and exam sessions ran smoothly by collaborating with the instructor and assisting students wherever needed

OUTREACH AND ENGAGEMENT

2026-present **STEM Center for Outreach, Research, and Education**

Role: Graduate Mentor

Responsibilities:

- Provide 1-1 mentorship to undergraduate students
- Support mentees in academic writing, research, and publications

2025-present **Psychophysiology Journal Club**

Role: Creator & organizer

Description: Cross-institutional journal club promoting scholarship and training related to psychophysiology

Presented five times

2024-present **Psychoneuroimmunology Journal Club**

Role: Regular attendee

Description: Pittsburgh-based cross-institutional journal club exploring new research published on PNI

Presented once

2026 **STEM Center for Outreach, Research, and Education – Summer Camp**

Role: Summer Camp Assistant

Responsibilities:

- Assisted in lesson plan and camp activity preparation
- Designed camp materials in Canva to have a cohesive and engaging style
- Aided teachers in lesson facilitation
- Helped campers complete activities centered around surviving in the wilderness and forensic science